

X-MEN

Earth's mightiest team

X-MEN

FACTFILE

MEMBERS AND POWERS

PROFESSOR X (Charles Xavier)

Telepathy

CYCLOPS (Scott Summers)

Optic power beams

PHOENIX (Marvel Girl I, Jean Grey)

Telepathy, telekinesis

ARCHANGEL (Angel, Warren Worthington III)

Flight

BEAST (Henry McCoy)

Superhuman strength and agility

ICEMAN (Bobby Drake)

Generates intense cold

COLOSSUS (Peter Rasputin)

Turns to "organic steel"

NIGHTCRAWLER (Kurt Wagner)

Teleportation

ROGUE (Real name unrevealed)

Absorbs memories and abilities

SHADOWCAT (Kitty Pryde)

"Phases" through solid objects

STORM (Ororo Munroe)

Controls weather

WOLVERINE (Logan)

Adamantium skeleton and claws

BASE The Xavier Institute, Salem Center, New York State

FIRST APPEARANCE

X-Men #1 (September 1963)

ALLIES The New Mutants, Excalibur, X-Factor, Generation X, the Fantastic Four, the Avengers, Spider-Man, Doctor Strange

FOES Magneto, the Juggernaut, the Sentinels, Apocalypse, Mister Sinister, Mystique, Brotherhood of Evil Mutants, the Hellfire Club, the Brood

ISSUE #1

Professor X trains his X-Men and the team are confronted with arch-enemy Magneto.



The X-Men are a team of superhuman mutants that was founded by Professor Charles Xavier (Professor X), who is not only a mutant himself, but is also one of the world's leading authorities on mutation. In founding the X-Men, Xavier had two principal purposes. First, he sought to find young mutants and to train them in utilizing their superhuman powers. Second, Xavier intended the X-Men to serve as a combat team to defend "ordinary" humans against attack by other mutants. Further, Xavier recognizes that "normal" humans tend to fear and distrust the mutants who are appearing in their midst, and that therefore mutants often suffer persecution.

XAVIER'S DREAM

In founding the X-Men, Xavier created a community of mutants living together on his estate. Xavier is a visionary who hopes to help bring about peaceful coexistence between mutants and the rest of the human race. The X-Men are dedicated to this goal, which they call "Xavier's dream." Xavier has explained that he named the team "X-Men" after the "extra" powers that his mutant students possess. (Of course, "X" is also the first letter of Xavier's last name.)

As a young man, Xavier battled another mutant telepath, Amahl Farouk, alias the Shadow King, in Egypt. This encounter made him aware of the need to protect humanity from malevolent mutants.

ROAD TO RECOVERY

Xavier subsequently lost the use of his legs in a clash with an alien who called himself Lucifer. Deeply depressed, Xavier led a reclusive existence at his family mansion. However, he began treating a ten-year-old girl named Jean Grey whose mutant powers had emerged prematurely.

Years later, the FBI initiated an investigation of mutants, headed by agent Fred Duncan. Xavier met

ESSENTIAL STORYLINES

• **Giant-Size X-Men #1**

Charles Xavier forms a new international team of X-Men.

• **The Uncanny X-Men #129-137**

"The Dark Phoenix Saga": the X-Men try to stop the mad Phoenix (Jean Grey) from wreaking havoc through the cosmos and save her from insanity.

• **The Uncanny X-Men #141-142**

"Days of Future Past": present day X-Men try to prevent a future America ruled by Sentinels.



THE X-MEN

- 1 Storm
- 2 Banshee
- 3 Angel
- 4 Sunfire
- 5 Iceman
- 6 Havok
- 7 Polaris
- 8 Marvel Girl (Jean Grey)
- 9 Colossus
- 10 Nightcrawler
- 11 Wolverine
- 12 Cyclops
- 13 Thunderbird



The X-Men are based in Charles Xavier's Westchester County mansion.

with Duncan and volunteered to locate young mutants and train them in managing their potentially dangerous abilities. Duncan agreed to the plan and pledged to keep Xavier's work with mutants secret. Xavier soon recruited five adolescent mutants to his school, giving each of them codenames: Cyclops, Iceman, the Angel (see ARCHANGEL), the Beast, and Marvel Girl (the teenage Jean Grey). All five were enrolled at Professor Xavier's School

for Gifted Youngsters, a private school based in Xavier's mansion, in the town of Salem Center in New York City's Westchester County.

There Xavier educated them in conventional academic subjects, while secretly teaching them how to utilize their mutant abilities.

The next member of the X-Men, who served only briefly, was the MIMIC, who was not a mutant but had the ability to imitate mutant powers. During a period when Xavier was in seclusion, he was impersonated by the CHANGELING, a shapeshifting mutant who died heroically. The mutants HAVOK and Lorna Dane, later known as POLARIS, joined the team subsequently.

NEW RECRUITS

Most of the X-Men became trapped on the island of Krakoa, which proved to be a gigantic mutant organism. Xavier then recruited a new team of X-Men from various countries. The new members included the BANSHEE, from Ireland; Colossus, from Russia; NIGHTCRAWLER, from Germany; Storm, from equatorial Africa; SUNFIRE, from Japan; THUNDERBIRD, a Native American; and WOLVERINE, from Canada.

Led by Cyclops, the new recruits rescued the X-Men from Krakoa. After their return, the senior X-Men left the team, except for Cyclops, who remained as deputy leader. Sunfire quit, and Thunderbird was killed during the new X-Men's second mission.

Over subsequent years, many other members

have joined the X-Men, including Kitty Pryde, alias Shadowcat; ROGUE; Rachel Summers, known both as the second Phoenix and the current Marvel Girl; PSYLOCKE; the DAZZLER; and LONGSHOT. During a temporary reformation, even the X-Men's archfoe Magneto even joined the team.

After forming their own group, X-FACTOR, the five founding X-Men returned to their original team. Xavier's school was renamed the Xavier Institute. Further new members included FORGE, JUBILEE, GAMBIT, BISHOP, REVANCHE, CANNONBALL, Joseph (a clone of Magneto),

Dr. Cecilia Reyes, MARROW and MAGGOET.

Storm organized a short-lived spinoff team called the X-Treme X-Men, which included, SAGE, the third THUNDERBIRD, LIFEGUARD and Slipstream. Most of these members joined the main X-Men team.

OPEN SECRET

Many other heroes have joined the X-Men over the years, including CABLE, CHAMBER, HUSK, NORTHSTAR, Stacy X, and the traitor XORN. Even former foes like Emma Frost, JUGGERNAUT, and MYSTIQUE have been part of the team. Ever since Professor X's evil twin sister Cassandra Nova exposed him as a mutant, the world has known that the Xavier

Institute was the headquarters of the X-Men. This made it possible for the Institute to openly advocate for mutant rights. In the aftermath of M-Day, the government made the X Mansion a sort of reservation for mutants, keeping the few remaining ones there, purportedly for their safety.

PS, MF

CEREBRO

Cerebro is a machine invented by Professor Charles Xavier to locate mutants possessing superhuman abilities. Cerebro accomplishes this by detecting psionic energy emitted by the minds of superhuman mutants. Cerebro operates best when it is linked to the mind of a telepath, such as Xavier or Jean Grey, through a headset. Xavier utilized an early version of Cerebro, called Cybemo, to locate Scott Summers, who became Cyclops. On combining with the Sentinel Bastion's nanotechnology, Cerebro became sentient. It posed a menace until Xavier destroyed it. Since then Xavier has created an advanced version, called Cerebra.



Among the X-Men's adversaries are Sabretooth (left, fighting Wolverine), the insect-like alien Brood (battling Cyclops), and their leading nemesis Magneto (top right, attacking Bishop).

